



Sanskriti Model United Nations 2026

**DISARMAMENT AND
INTERNATIONAL SECURITY
COMMITTEE**

Paperwork & Procedural Guide

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NOTE FROM THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Dear Delegates,

The Executive Board welcomes you to the committee. This guide has been prepared to assist you in understanding the rules of procedure, documentation formats, and the overall functioning of the committee. Delegates are strongly encouraged to read this document carefully before the commencement of the conference and to keep it accessible throughout committee sessions.

This guide is intended to serve as your primary reference for how debate will progress, how motions will be raised, and how action can be taken within the committee. The paperwork section contains essential formats and expectations that will be used extensively during committee proceedings. The guide also includes sample documentation formats to help you understand the required structure and level of detail.

In case of any confusion regarding procedure, documentation, or expectations, delegates are encouraged to reach out to the Executive Board for clarification.

Delegates are also requested to carefully note the Position Paper submission deadline:

11:59 PM, April 18th, 2026

Timely submission of the position paper is mandatory, and delays will not be entertained.

We look forward to a productive and engaging committee.

Regards,
The Executive Board

PART I | RULES OF PROCEDURE

All committees at Model United Nations conferences are required to follow certain rules and regulations. This section introduces the same, and delegates are requested to read it thoroughly.

MOTIONS

A motion is a proposal by a delegate to steer the flow of debate, agenda, or discussion, which is then voted upon by the committee at large. A motion is used when a delegate wants to have an act passed that affects the entire committee. A delegate can propose a motion when the chair asks for motions on the floor.

While raising a motion, a delegate must specify their allotment, per speaker time, and total speakers' time, where applicable.

1. Motion to Open the General Speakers List

A motion to open the General Speakers List is used when a delegate intends to open the floor for general debate.

Example:

"The delegate of the United States of America would like to raise a motion to open the General Speakers List, per speaker time being 90 seconds and total time being 30 minutes."

Each delegate will have a total speaking time of 90 seconds and the approximate total time for the General Speakers List would be 30 minutes.

2. Motion to Raise a Moderated Caucus

This motion is employed when a delegate wishes to start a moderated caucus — a form of debate where delegates deliberate and discuss a specific sub-topic of the agenda.

Example:

"The delegate of Iraq motions for a ten-minute moderated caucus with a thirty-second speaking time for the purpose of discussing education in India."

3. Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

A motion for an unmoderated caucus is raised when a delegate wishes to step into informal debate, a usually brief period (10 to 30 minutes) where delegates can lobby and discuss what direction they would like the committee to take.

Example:

"The delegate of Russia motions for a ten-minute unmoderated caucus."

4. Motion to Introduce Working Papers, Resolutions, and Amendments

This motion is introduced when a delegate wants to formally introduce a working paper, draft resolution, or amendment to the committee, that is, to read out the document and make it an official committee document.

Example:

"The delegate of Saudi Arabia would like to introduce the Draft Resolution of the United Bloc."

5. Motion to Close Debate and Move into Voting Procedure

This motion is used when a delegate wishes to end debate on a topic and move into voting procedure. There will be two speakers for and two speakers against this motion. This motion can be put forward at any time, though it will not be taken seriously unless an ample amount of debate on the issue has already occurred.

Example:

"The delegate of Zimbabwe would like to raise a motion to close debate and move into formal voting procedure."

6. Motion for a Roll Call Vote

This motion is used during the voting procedure. It is automatically adopted with the chair's approval, or may be raised by a delegate when moving into the voting procedure.

During a roll call vote, delegates may respond in the following ways:

Yes — voting in favour of the document at hand.

No — voting against the document.

Yes with Rights — voting in favour while reserving the right to explain the vote.

No with Rights — voting against while reserving the right to explain the vote.

Abstain — choosing to neither vote for nor against.

Pass — deferring the vote temporarily (if permitted by the chair).

Example:

"The delegate of China would like to raise a motion for a roll call vote."

7. Motion to Recess

This motion is used to suspend debate at the end of each committee session. Once the chair announces that they will take a motion to recess, a delegate may raise this motion.

Example:

"The delegate of Belgium would like to raise a motion to recess."

8. Motion to Adjourn

This motion is used to formally end the last committee session and conclude the conference. A delegate can raise this motion when the chair asks for a motion to adjourn on the floor.

Example:

"The delegate of Portugal would like to raise a motion to adjourn."

POINTS

In general, points are a way to ask a question in committee or to bring something of non-substantive importance to the committee's attention. They are tools used by delegates to address procedural issues, personal comfort, or to raise questions during committee sessions.

Point of Personal Privilege

This point is used when a delegate's ability to participate in the committee is impaired. For example, if they need to visit the medical room or require logistical support.

Using too many Points of Personal Privilege can be unproductive. Use this point very sparingly and only if the issue is truly impairing your ability to delegate. This point may only be raised during another delegate's speech in cases of audibility issues. It is looked upon unfavourably if used simply to interrupt or unsettle other delegates.

Point of Information

This is used when a delegate has a substantive question for a speaker — usually based on their speech, during formal debate, after the delegate has finished speaking. This point can be used any time the chair indicates that questions are in order.

Point of Order

A delegate can raise a Point of Order when there is a violation of the rules of procedure. The chair will decide immediately whether a violation has occurred, and if so, it will be corrected or stopped.

A Point of Order is a very serious procedural matter and should be used responsibly — only when a delegate is certain a rule has been broken. If unsure, consider rephrasing the concern as a Point of Parliamentary Inquiry at a more appropriate moment. Note that a Point of Order cannot be used to point out factual inaccuracies in a delegate's speech; the chair will have noted any major inaccuracies. All chairs are well-versed in official rules, but retain the ability to adopt rules of debate at their own discretion. Any modifications will be announced at the beginning of the conference.

Right to Reply

A Right to Reply can be used if a member of the committee makes a personal attack on another delegate. The affected delegate is then permitted to reply. However, if an attack is

made on a delegate's position or policy — rather than on them personally — the delegate does not receive a Right of Reply.

Distinction:

"Country A has an uncomfortably bright shirt..." — deserves a Right to Reply.

"Country B's idea of satellites is idiotic..." — does NOT deserve a Right to Reply.

Note: A Right to Reply must be requested directly after the personal attack is made. The chair makes the ultimate ruling as to whether or not the delegate deserves a Right to Reply. It may not be used to interrupt committee proceedings.

YIELDS AND COMMENTS

After their speech, a delegate may yield their remaining time in the following ways:

Yield to the Chair

After the completion of a speakers list speech, a delegate may yield to the chair. This means that the chair will absorb any remaining time in the speech — nothing further will occur with the remaining time.

Yield to Points of Information

After completing their speech, a delegate may yield to questions. With the remaining time, the chair will call upon other delegates to ask the speaker questions pertaining to the speech that was just given.

Note: The time taken for a delegate to ask a question will not be counted towards the time remaining in the speech.

Yield to Comments

After completing their speech, a delegate may yield to comments. This means that two thirty-second speeches can be made by any delegate, the chair will call on two delegates who wish to make comments. Comments must pertain to the original speech.

Yield to Another Delegate

After completing their speech, a delegate may yield to another delegate. With the remaining time, that delegate will be able to elaborate on the ideas presented by the first speaker. The second speaker may not introduce a topic the first speaker did not mention.

Important: Only one yield may be made per speaker on the speakers list. If the speaker intends to yield to another delegate, they should confirm in advance that the delegate will accept the time and is willing to speak.

CHITS

Chits can be submitted to the Executive Board in case a delegate wants to bring important points to the Board's attention that they were unable to raise through a speech. The chit must be handed to a logistical member, who will pass it to the Executive Board.

Chit to Another Delegate

A chit sent directly to another delegate. This chit will not be marked and must be sent directly — NOT via the Executive Board.

Chit to the Executive Board

A chit sent directly to the Executive Board for their attention.

Chit to Another Delegate via the Executive Board

This chit will first go to the Executive Board for marking, and will then be delivered to the addressed delegate. Chits of this type are usually Points of Information chits, or chits containing questions a delegate wishes to ask another based on their speech.

Note: Although a delegate may send Points of Information chits to another delegate, it is highly recommended that they speak up in committee whenever possible.

Substantive Chit

In case there is additional information that could not be covered in a speech or document, a delegate may send it to the Executive Board via a substantive chit for marking. A substantive chit may contain extra information, specified research, cited articles of the UN Charter, excess parts of a speech, or any other information the delegate wishes the Executive Board to note.

Important: A substantive chit must be fully handwritten.

PART II | PAPERWORK GUIDELINES

A. WORKING PAPERS

Working papers are often the precursors to draft resolutions in that they can outline the issues of a topic area or propose solutions without a particular format. A working paper may not be voted upon and may only contain signatories. Some chairs, however, may request that working papers be submitted in resolution format.

Note: For this committee, working papers will have both authors and signatories. Using a resolution format may also prove useful when converting the document to a draft resolution. Additional specifics regarding the maximum number of authors for working papers will be communicated to delegates in committee.

Recommended Format for Working Papers

Working papers should ideally be structured using the following format:

Main Clause;
Main Clause:
 (Sub-clause),
 (Sub-clause),
 (Sub-clause):
 (Sub-sub-clause),
 (Sub-sub-clause),
 (Sub-sub-clause);

B. DRAFT RESOLUTION

The days of debate are ultimately directed towards reaching a consensus and forming a resolution — known as the Draft Resolution (DR) — that delineates how Member States must tackle the various issues of the agenda. A good draft resolution requires a well-rounded approach and must be supported with a realistic framework for implementation. Delegates must ensure that all solutions proposed during committee or presented in the Draft Resolution fall within the purview of the mandate of the Disarmament and International Security Committee.

Preambulatory Clauses

Each preambulatory clause begins with a present participle — called a preambulatory phrase — which is italicised, and the clause always ends with a comma. These clauses may include references to the UN Charter, citations of past UN resolutions or treaties, acknowledgment of

statements made by the Secretary-General or a UN body or agency, recognition of the efforts of regional or non-governmental organisations, and general statements on the topic and its importance.

Sample Preambulatory Phrases

Affirming • Exercising • Realizing
Alarmed by • Expressing its appreciation • Recognising
Approving • Fulfilling • Recalling
Bearing in mind • Fully aware of • Referring
Believing • Expressing • Seeking
Confident • In appreciation • Taking into consideration
Contemplating • Further recalling • Taking note
Convinced • Guided by • Viewing with appreciation
Deeply concerned • Having examined • Deeply conscious
Having received • Regretting • Deeply convinced
Keeping in mind • Considering • Deeply disturbed
Noting with deep concern • Deeply regretting • Noting with satisfaction
Desiring • Further noting • Having deliberated
Expecting • Observing • Noting
Emphasizing • Reaffirming • Further desiring
Further realizing • Further recalling • Expressing its discontent

Operative Clauses

Operative clauses are meant to offer solutions to issues addressed during the proceedings of the committee. These clauses are action-oriented and should include both an underlined verb at the beginning of the sentence followed by the proposed solution. Each clause should support the next and continue to build upon the overall solution; delegates should add sufficient detail to ensure a complete and implementable solution.

Operative Clause Formatting Rules

1. Clauses must be numbered.
2. Each clause should support another and continue to build upon the solution.
3. Add sufficient detail to your clauses to present a complete solution.
4. Operative clauses must be punctuated by a semicolon, with the exception of the last operative clause which should end with a period.

Important: Do not use periods or full stops within the body of the Draft Resolution. If a Draft Resolution contains more than 3 periods, it will be scrapped.

Sample Operative Phrases

Accepts • Regrets • Affirms
Further requests • Considers • Proclaims
Draws attention • Reaffirms • Endorses
Expects • Expresses • Advises
Expresses its hope • Further recommends • Further invites
Strongly suggests • Further reminds • Welcomes
Reminds • Stresses • Invites
Notes • Suggests • Further encourages

C. POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

A Position Paper is a pre-committee document submitted to the Executive Board to give a basic outline of the delegate's understanding of the topic at hand. Furthermore, the paper highlights the delegate's knowledge of the allocation they are representing in committee. Most importantly, the paper must include an outlined course of action that the delegate wishes to take in committee.

Formatting Requirements

- The position paper must be one to two pages in length.
- Margins must be set at 1 inch or 2.54 cm.
- The font must be Times New Roman, sized between 10 pt. and 12 pt.
- The allocation name, committee name, and name of the student must be clearly mentioned at the top of the first page.
- The agenda must be clearly mentioned at the top of the page.
- The 'Justify' alignment must be used throughout.
- The final copy must be converted to PDF format before submission.

Structure

The position paper must be divided into three sections. The names and content recommendations for each are provided below. Delegates may select relevant pointers from these recommendations and develop them in their own voice.

Section1: Introduction to the Agenda

- Topic Understanding
- History
- Main Issues

- Major Events
- Direct/indirect effects
- Past Actions (Resolutions, Forums, Committees)
- Current Situation: updates on issue, main issues, direct/indirect effects

Section 2: Country Stance

- Foreign Policy
- Statements by the head of state
- Country's relation to the agenda, if any
- History of the agenda in the country
- Current situation and how the allocation is addressing it

Section 3: Solutions & Bibliography

- Future Outlook
- Outline for committee
- Listed recommendations to resolve the issue
- Conclusion
- Bibliography (use MLA5 citation format)

Recommendations

- Always represent the views of your allocation. Even when describing a conflict, do so from the perspective of your allocation.
- Be solution-oriented and concise. Back your paper with relevant policies, statistics, and steps taken by your allocation.
- Choose your authentic solutions over readily available ones, even if they are not as comprehensive — this provides a greater learning opportunity for the entire committee and fosters an environment of genuine collaboration.

Important: Plagiarism is strictly prohibited at Sanskriti Model UN. Never present someone else's work — whether from another delegate, a website, a research paper, or an organisation — as your own. Delegates who plagiarise their position paper or any other committee document will be barred from the award ceremony.

Note: All position papers must be emailed to unga2026.smun@gmail.com by 11:59 PM IST on 18th April. Papers received after the deadline will not be considered, and the delegate will not be eligible for awards.

